



Taking Action Based on Community Feedback NRA Conference Hall, 9th May 2017

Participants: NRA, Nepal Jesuit Social Institute (NJSI), Nomad Concepts Group, CARE-Nepal, Habitat for Humanity, Lutheran World Relief, DFID, Red Cross, Helvetas, Medair, Rotary Club, Youth Initiative, BBC Media Action, WOCHEND, and UN RCO.

The meeting was chaired by Mr. Prakash Thapa, Joint Secretary of NRA, Housing Division. Mr. Thapa opened the meeting and introduced the [Common Feedback Project](#) (CFP) and explained how useful the data is for NRA to understand what impression people in communities have of the reconstruction and the NRA.

CFP [presented](#) the findings from the latest [reconstruction report](#). Improvement can be seen in almost every question compared to the previous reconstruction report in [February 2017](#). The major findings were as follows:

- 47% of people said their reconstruction needs were not being addressed compared to 55% in January
- 41% of people reported that they have not consulted an engineer regarding their reconstruction compared to 45% in January. The main reasons for not consulting an engineer are that they haven't started construction, they can't get the engineers to come, or they don't trust the advice the engineers provide. Nuwakot and Sindhupalchowk are the districts where there was the highest level of reported challenges in getting an engineer to visit and this could be because the engineers are stretched quite thin in those districts. There are also cases where different engineers are providing conflicting advice which is frustrating and confusing for households.
- The level of respondents that report receiving reconstruction support was 80% in March compared to 69% in January.
- 50% of people reported that they are committing their own resources to reconstructing their house compared to 46% in January. Men are more likely than women to have committed their own resources, and Janjatis commit their own resources more frequently than other castes / ethnic groups. The status of reconstruction also makes a difference; 13% of respondents have completed their house and of these 80% had committed their own resources to do so. Of those who committed their own resources, 50% have taken a loan and there is limited data on the interest rates but potentially they are very high and this will have implications on long term recovery.
- 74% of people report that they do not face any barriers to reconstruction compared to 62% in January. The main contributor to this improvement is grievances being addressed.
- 64% of people are satisfied with the grant dispersal process compared to 52% in January. The biggest difference between respondents comes from the status of their house construction; if their construction is ongoing or has finished they are generally satisfied.
- 62% of people reported that they feel the reconstruction is making progress, an increase from 49% in January. There has been huge progress since June 2016 when only 22% people felt the reconstruction was making progress.
- 71% of people reported having the information they need to access support compared to 58% in January. This is great progress but there is a big variation across different demographics. Women always feel they have less information than men. In urban areas people reporting having more information than in rural areas. Marginalised and indigenous groups feel they have less access to information. This may not be surprising but it comes up very consistently in all reports. How can we target our technical assistance activities to these groups? During this round of the survey people were asked what their mother tongue is which hadn't been done previously. The people who reported having the least access to information were people whose mother tongue is Tamang and Gurung, how can we address this?



- 12% of respondents said they will only start reconstructing their house after they receive the 2nd tranche. This is down from 17% in the previous round of the survey. When the 12% respondents are considered by ethnicity this triangulates the information for the question above as 17% of Tamang respondents (close to 300) and 16% of Dalit respondents are waiting for the 2nd tranche.
- The biggest reconstruction priority other than house reconstruction is access to water. This has always been a priority but it is continuously increasing and it is now the main priority across all geographical areas and groups. Two months ago, disaggregation by groups led to different priorities coming out but now it always comes out as access to water.
- Action points were proposed as follows: district coordination working groups for technical assistance staff (government and POs), expand coverage of vulnerable top ups, provide support for households to prepare and approve house designs, establish water supply working group, and communications methods – consider how to include marginalised groups.

Questions and Discussion

Q: Is there a timeframe for launching the proposed working group on WASH?

There is no fixed plan at this point, it is just a suggestion but if there is interest HRRP and CFP can take this forward to see what is possible.

Q: Why does the CFP survey not include questions on public buildings and community infrastructure?

The last question in the survey asks people what their main priority is aside from housing reconstruction. This is the question where water supply is coming up very strongly across all areas.

Q: In your presentation, you showed that a significant number of people are unhappy with the grant dispersal process, do you know why?

Important to highlight that most people are satisfied with the grant dispersal process. Where people are not satisfied it's generally because they find the process complicated and they don't feel that the first tranche is sufficient to start building.

Q: Do you ask communities what the possible solutions might be?

This is a good idea, it's something that has come up in Focus Group Discussions (FGDs) that CFP have done in the past. For example, in Bigu, Dolakha the village were rebuilding each house one by one in a queue using their own labour. This was working well but there was an issue that houses of single women were not part of the queue. CFP will consider the possibility of including this in future surveys.

Q: Can you tell us more about water supply working group, what do you envisage?

It is not clear what shape this would take but water supply is an issue that has been coming up in every CFP survey over the past two years and it is getting worse. The suggestion is about bringing relevant people together to coordinate and plan a way forward. There may also be a need to have an assessment of the situation to understand technically where the real gaps are in water supply and what the solutions might be. The next CFP report on reconstruction will come out in July so there will be a chance to see if there is a difference in access to water because of the monsoon, but this will be a short-term fix and the same issues will come up again during the next dry season.

Q: Do households find it difficult to collect and manage materials and resources? Is this a barrier?

This is one barrier; 39% of the people who report that their needs are not met say building materials are one of their needs but this is down from 2 months ago. People who have received the 1st tranche but haven't started building generally say it is because water, labour, and / or material being too expensive or not available.



Q: What have you found about landless people? What are the issues related to this?

Doesn't come up as much as CFP thought it would and it came up less this month than in previous months but CFP don't have a lot of good data on this topic. The revised grievance addressal procedures have likely made a difference as land ownership can be verified by neighbours. The NRA has also published the resettlement procedures, which have been approved by cabinet, allowing for a grant of up to 200,000 NPRs be provided for purchase of land. These procedures also include provision for cases where the beneficiaries were residing in government lands or other kinds of land which cannot be transferred, NRA has announced that these households will be eligible to receive an additional grant of up to 200,000 NPRs to purchase land. After the land has been purchased they will be eligible to receive the housing reconstruction grant of 300,000 NPRs to support the reconstruction of their home.

Q: Did the survey find that many people who have already completed their reconstruction have received the reconstruction grant? We have found that these people are not receiving the grant and have very high interest loans.

In Sindhupalchowk the last survey found that 98% of people had received support but less than 50% had consulted an engineer. There is a lot of tension in communities at the moment because of houses that have been built but are not compliant. People are expecting that they will get the grant but are then having to deal with making corrections to their construction to make it compliant. There is a fear that engineers will face huge pressure from communities to approve houses even if they aren't compliant.

Q: There are many barriers in reconstruction, how can NGOs support? What is the process that CFP uses to select the respondents and the sample size?

A scientific process is used to select respondents and sample size and this has been agreed with DFID and others to confirm it is valid. NGOs should be providing comprehensive socio-technical assistance to support households to overcome barriers in reconstruction. NGOs can also support the formation and strengthening of Community Reconstruction Committees (CRCs).

Q: We are now two years into the reconstruction, has the NRA assessed the weaknesses and determined which areas need improvement?

There is a need for a continual process of improvement and restructuring to meet the needs. Need everyone to come together to look at how to address people thinking that they will start after the 2nd tranche? The positive increases in some areas of the survey are very encouraging but there are lots of cases miscommunication which need to be addressed. We all need to work together on this and move forward with positive steps.

Q: NRA is working on the Corrections and Exceptions Manual, when will it be finished?

The [manual](#) is already complete. Training of trainers will take place soon and then those trainers will roll out training across all the districts for all field level technical staff.

Q: Which organisations can support coordination of technical assistance teams at Gaupalika / Nagarpalika level?

Medair (Ramechhap), CARE (Sindhupalchowk, Gorkha, and Dhading), NOMAD (Gorkha), Helvetas (Makwanpur, Sindhuli, Okhaldhunga, and Rasuwa), and Habitat for Humanity (Nuwakot and Kavre) expressed interest in supporting this. BBC Media Action also informed that they are working with local radio partners in 11 districts and that maybe they can coordinate with them to work on communication materials to support these events. BBC Media Action also informed that they had just come from a visit to Okhaldhunga and Ramechhap where they had met very committed and sincere engineers and they were surprised that the media is saying that there is nothing happening in reconstruction. It is important to be positive sometimes as well.

Mr. Prakash Thapa closed the meeting by thanking CFP, HRRP, and all participants for the lively and interactive meeting.



Action Points

Actions	Responsible / Committed	Timeframe
Technical Assistance:		
Equip staff at VDC level with skills to be able to communicate effectively with communities	POs, MoUD DL-PIUs, MoUD CL-PIU, MoFALD	As soon as possible, continuous
Expand coverage of door to door technical assistance teams: - Collect FAQs from communities and share to HRRP for compilation and dissemination, - Provide budgeting and finance information, - Orientations for political / community leaders, - Improve targeting of TA particularly to provide women with info that they need	POs, MoUD DL-PIUs, DL-PIU engineers	As soon as possible, continuous
Expand coverage of helpdesks/technical resource centres: - Provide design preparation and approval support for HHs / Communities, - Provide budgeting and finance information, - Orientations for vendors and producers, info and demos on material quality	POs, MoUD DL-PIUs, DL-PIU engineers	As soon as possible, continuous
Monthly orientations for VDC level reconstruction staff / teams (GoN and POs)	MoFALD and MoUD CL-PIUs and DL-PIUs, NRA, HRRP, POs	As soon as possible, continuous Funding required
Training:		
Monitor quality of training	Training providers	As soon as possible, continuous
Provide refresher training for masons	Training providers	As soon as possible, continuous
Redistribute planned investment in training to have even coverage	Training providers, donors	As soon as possible, continuous
Proper selection of participants for training courses based on relevant criteria	Training providers	As soon as possible, continuous
Expand opportunities for training for women and men over 40	Training providers	
Top Up Grants: expand coverage for vulnerable/remote HHs	POs	As soon as possible
Supply Chain: assessment and development of plan based on assessment findings	NRA, MoUD / DUDBC, HRRP, Practical Action, POs in districts	End May
Water Supply:		
Update information on water sources, prepare plan to maximise investment in water supply programmes to support HHs with reconstruction	HRRP, DWSS / WASH Cluster, NRA, POs with WASH programmes	As soon as possible, continuous
Establish working group to address water access issues	HRRP, DWSS / WASH Cluster, NRA, HCT, relevant POs	As soon as possible



CFP and HRRP will be following up with the participants in the session directly to try to secure more precise commitments in relation to the actions above. Please feel free to contact the presenters, contact details are provided below, if your organisation can contribute to any of the above.

Reference Documents

- [CFP Reconstruction Report, April 2017](#)
- [CFP Reconstruction Report, February 2017](#)
- [CFP Focus Group Discussion Report, January 2017](#)
- [Contact details for District Focal Points for DL-PIU engineers:](#) able to provide contact details for DL-PIU engineers at VDC level.
- [Sakchyam programme financial capability resources, you tube channel](#)
- [NRA map of water sources, May 2016](#)
- [NRA map of damage grade, 14 districts](#)
- [Damage grade map, 31 districts](#)
- [Maps of coverage of full package of technical assistance](#)
- [Nepal National Building Code, revised NBC 202, 203, 204, and 205](#)
- [JICA Minimum Requirements Booklets for Households](#)
- [JICA Masons Training Survey Format](#)
- [JICA Refresher Training for Masons](#)
- [HRRP Briefing Pack](#)
- [HRRP Weekly Bulletins](#)
- [HRRP Q&A](#)

Contact Details

Contact details for the presenters are provided below to facilitate follow up on any of the topics covered in the session.

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